

Python: exercises on functions

This notebook was generated in pseudocode mode.

Exercise: Greeting Function

Exercise Description

Create a function `greet` that takes a user's name as input and prints a greeting message. The function should have a default parameter that uses "Fabio" as the default name if no name is provided.

The function should print: "Hello, [name]! Welcome!"

Your solution

```
def greet(name="Fabio"):
    # step 1: create a greeting message by concatenating "Hello, " with the name and "! Welco
    # step 2: print the greeting message
```

Test your solution

```
# Test the function with default parameter
import io
import sys
from contextlib import redirect_stdout

# Capture output from greet() with default parameter
f = io.StringIO()
with redirect_stdout(f):
    greet()
output = f.getvalue().strip()
assert output == "Hello, Fabio! Welcome!"
```

Test your solution

```
# Test the function with custom name
f = io.StringIO()
with redirect_stdout(f):
    greet("Alice")
output = f.getvalue().strip()
assert output == "Hello, Alice! Welcome!"
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Even or Odd Checker Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `is_even` that takes an integer as input and returns `True` if the number is even, `False` if it's odd.

Your solution

```
def is_even(number):  
    # step 1: check if the number modulo 2 equals 0 (meaning it's divisible by 2)  
    # step 2: return True if the condition is true, False otherwise
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with even number  
assert is_even(4) == True  
assert is_even(0) == True  
assert is_even(100) == True
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with odd number
assert is_even(3) == False
assert is_even(1) == False
assert is_even(99) == False
```

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```

Exercise: Maximum of Two Numbers

Exercise Description

Create a function `max_of_two` that returns the larger of two numbers. The second parameter should have a default value of 0.

Your solution

```
def max_of_two(a, b=0):
    # step 1: check if the first number is greater than the second number
```

```
# step 2: return the first number  
# step 3: otherwise  
# step 4: return the second number
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with two positive numbers  
assert max_of_two(5, 3) == 5  
assert max_of_two(2, 8) == 8  
assert max_of_two(10, 10) == 10
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with default parameter  
assert max_of_two(5) == 5 # 5 > 0 (default)  
assert max_of_two(-3) == 0 # -3 < 0 (default)
```

Debug your solution

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```

Exercise: Simple Calculator Function

Exercise Description

Implement a function `calculator` that takes two numbers and an operator (`+`, `-`, `*`, `/`) and returns the result of the operation. Handle division by zero and invalid operators appropriately.

Your solution

```
def calculator(a, b, operator):  
    # step 1: check if operator is '+' (addition)  
    # step 2: return the sum of a and b  
    # step 3: otherwise, check if operator is '-' (subtraction)  
    # step 4: return the difference of a and b  
    # step 5: otherwise, check if operator is '*' (multiplication)  
    # step 6: return the product of a and b  
    # step 7: otherwise, check if operator is '/' (division)  
    # step 8: check if b is not zero to avoid division by zero  
    # step 9: return the division of a by b  
    # step 10: otherwise (division by zero)  
    # step 11: return error message "Error: Division by zero"  
    # step 12: otherwise (invalid operator)  
    # step 13: return error message "Invalid operator"
```

Test your solution

```
# Test basic operations
assert calculator(10, 5, '+') == 15
assert calculator(10, 5, '-') == 5
assert calculator(10, 5, '*') == 50
assert calculator(10, 5, '/') == 2.0
```

Test your solution

```
# Test error cases
assert calculator(10, 0, '/') == "Error: Division by zero"
assert calculator(10, 5, '%') == "Invalid operator"
```

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```

Exercise: Temperature Converter Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `celsius_to_fahrenheit` that converts a temperature from Celsius to Fahrenheit using the formula: $F = (C \times 9/5) + 32$

Your solution

```
def celsius_to_fahrenheit(celsius):  
    # step 1: apply the conversion formula: multiply celsius by 9/5 and add 32  
    # step 2: return the calculated fahrenheit value
```

Test your solution

```
# Test common temperature conversions  
assert celsius_to_fahrenheit(0) == 32.0 # Freezing point  
assert celsius_to_fahrenheit(100) == 212.0 # Boiling point  
assert celsius_to_fahrenheit(25) == 77.0 # Room temperature
```

Test your solution

```
# Test negative temperatures  
assert celsius_to_fahrenheit(-10) == 14.0  
assert celsius_to_fahrenheit(-40) == -40.0 # Special case where C = F
```

Debug your solution

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```

Exercise: Factorial Calculator (Recursive)

Exercise Description

Create a recursive function `factorial` that returns the factorial of a given number. The function should have a default parameter with the value 10. Remember that factorial of n is $n! = n \times (n-1) \times (n-2) \times \dots \times 1$, and $0! = 1! = 1$.

Your solution

```
def factorial(n=10):  
    # step 1: check if n equals 0 or n equals 1 (base cases)  
    # step 2: return 1 (since 0! = 1! = 1)  
    # step 3: otherwise (recursive case)  
    # step 4: return n multiplied by factorial of (n-1)
```

Test your solution

```
# Test base cases  
assert factorial(0) == 1
```

```
assert factorial(1) == 1
```

Test your solution

```
# Test small factorials  
assert factorial(3) == 6   # 3! = 3 × 2 × 1 = 6  
assert factorial(4) == 24  # 4! = 4 × 3 × 2 × 1 = 24  
assert factorial(5) == 120 # 5! = 5 × 4 × 3 × 2 × 1 = 120
```

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from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Leap Year Checker Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `is_leap_year` that determines whether a given year is a leap year. A leap year is divisible by 4, but if it's divisible by 100, it must also be divisible by 400.

Your solution

```
def is_leap_year(year):  
    # step 1: check the complex leap year condition using logical operators  
    # step 2: check if year is divisible by 4 AND not divisible by 100  
    # step 3: OR check if year is divisible by 400  
    # step 4: if either condition is true, return True  
    # step 5: otherwise  
    # step 6: return False
```

Test your solution

```
# Test leap years  
assert is_leap_year(2024) == True # Divisible by 4, not by 100  
assert is_leap_year(2000) == True # Divisible by 400  
assert is_leap_year(1600) == True # Divisible by 400
```

Test your solution

```
# Test non-leap years  
assert is_leap_year(2023) == False # Not divisible by 4  
assert is_leap_year(1900) == False # Divisible by 100 but not by 400  
assert is_leap_year(2100) == False # Divisible by 100 but not by 400
```

Debug your solution

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from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Circle Area Calculator

Exercise Description

Implement a function `circle_area` that calculates the area of a circle given its radius. Use the formula:
 $\text{Area} = \pi \times \text{radius}^2$

Your solution

```
import math

def circle_area(radius):
    # step 1: calculate the area using the formula: pi times radius squared
    # step 2: return the calculated area
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with common radius values
import math
assert abs(circle_area(1) - math.pi) < 0.0001 # Area of unit circle
assert abs(circle_area(2) - 4 * math.pi) < 0.0001 # Area = 4π
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with larger radius
assert abs(circle_area(5) - 25 * math.pi) < 0.0001 # Area = 25π
assert circle_area(0) == 0 # Zero radius
```

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```

Exercise: Vowel Checker Function

Exercise Description

Create a function `is_vowel` that checks whether a given character is a vowel (a, e, i, o, u) in either uppercase or lowercase.

Your solution

```
def is_vowel(char):  
    # step 1: create a string containing all vowels in both lowercase and uppercase  
    # step 2: check if the given character is in the vowels string  
    # step 3: return True if found, False otherwise
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with lowercase vowels  
assert is_vowel('a') == True  
assert is_vowel('e') == True  
assert is_vowel('i') == True  
assert is_vowel('o') == True  
assert is_vowel('u') == True
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with uppercase vowels and consonants  
assert is_vowel('A') == True  
assert is_vowel('E') == True  
assert is_vowel('b') == False  
assert is_vowel('Z') == False
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Simple Interest Calculator

Exercise Description

Write a function `simple_interest` that calculates simple interest given principal amount, rate of interest, and time period. Use the formula: $\text{Simple Interest} = (\text{Principal} \times \text{Rate} \times \text{Time}) / 100$

Your solution

```
def simple_interest(principal, rate, time):  
    # step 1: calculate simple interest using the formula: (principal * rate * time) / 100  
    # step 2: return the calculated interest amount
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with common values
assert simple_interest(1000, 5, 2) == 100.0 # $1000 at 5% for 2 years
assert simple_interest(5000, 10, 1) == 500.0 # $5000 at 10% for 1 year
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with different scenarios
assert simple_interest(2000, 7.5, 3) == 450.0 # $2000 at 7.5% for 3 years
assert simple_interest(1000, 0, 5) == 0.0 # 0% interest rate
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Count Vowels Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `count_vowels` that counts the number of vowels (a, e, i, o, u) in a given string, ignoring case.

Your solution

```
def count_vowels(text):  
    # step 1: define a string containing all vowels in both cases  
    # step 2: initialize a counter to 0  
    # step 3: iterate through each character in the text  
        # step 4: check if the character is in the vowels string  
        # step 5: if yes, increment the counter  
    # step 6: return the total count
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with various strings  
assert count_vowels("hello") == 2 # e, o  
assert count_vowels("Python") == 1 # o  
assert count_vowels("aeiou") == 5 # All vowels
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with mixed case and edge cases  
assert count_vowels("HELLO") == 2 # E, O  
assert count_vowels("bcdfg") == 0 # No vowels  
assert count_vowels("") == 0 # Empty string
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Absolute Value Function

Exercise Description

Create a function `absolute` that returns the absolute value of a number (the non-negative value without regard to its sign).

Your solution

```
def absolute(num):  
    # step 1: check if the number is greater than or equal to 0  
    # step 2: return the number as is (it's already positive)  
    # step 3: otherwise (the number is negative)  
    # step 4: return the negative of the number (making it positive)
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with positive numbers
assert absolute(5) == 5
assert absolute(10.5) == 10.5
assert absolute(0) == 0
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with negative numbers
assert absolute(-5) == 5
assert absolute(-10.5) == 10.5
assert absolute(-100) == 100
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Maximum of Three Numbers

Exercise Description

Write a function `max_of_three` that returns the largest of three numbers.

Your solution

```
def max_of_three(a, b, c):  
    # step 1: check if a is greater than or equal to both b and c  
    # step 2: return a as the maximum  
    # step 3: otherwise, check if b is greater than or equal to both a and c  
    # step 4: return b as the maximum  
    # step 5: otherwise (c must be the maximum)  
    # step 6: return c as the maximum
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with different maximum positions  
assert max_of_three(10, 5, 8) == 10 # First is maximum  
assert max_of_three(3, 15, 7) == 15 # Second is maximum  
assert max_of_three(4, 6, 20) == 20 # Third is maximum
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with equal values  
assert max_of_three(5, 5, 5) == 5 # All equal  
assert max_of_three(10, 10, 8) == 10 # Two equal maximums
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Power Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `power` that calculates the power of a number (base raised to the exponent).

Your solution

```
def power(base, exponent):  
    # step 1: calculate base raised to the power of exponent using the ** operator  
    # step 2: return the calculated result
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with common power calculations  
assert power(2, 3) == 8 # 2^3 = 8  
assert power(5, 2) == 25 # 5^2 = 25  
assert power(10, 0) == 1 # Any number to power 0 is 1
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with edge cases  
assert power(3, 1) == 3 # Any number to power 1 is itself  
assert power(2, 4) == 16 # 2^4 = 16
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Palindrome Checker Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `is_palindrome` that checks whether a given string reads the same forwards and backwards.

Your solution

```
def is_palindrome(text):  
    # step 1: convert the text to lowercase for case-insensitive comparison  
    # step 2: compare the text with its reverse  
    # step 3: return True if they are equal, False otherwise
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with palindromes  
assert is_palindrome("racecar") == True  
assert is_palindrome("level") == True  
assert is_palindrome("a") == True # Single character
```

Test your solution

```
# Test with non-palindromes and case variations  
assert is_palindrome("hello") == False  
assert is_palindrome("Racecar") == True # Case insensitive  
assert is_palindrome("python") == False
```

Debug your solution

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from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Calculate Body Mass Index (BMI)

Exercise Description

Write a function `calculate_bmi(weight, height)` that returns the Body Mass Index given weight (in kilograms) and height (in meters). The BMI is computed as `weight / (height**2)`.

Your solution

```
def calculate_bmi(weight, height):  
    # compute the body mass index by dividing the weight by the square of the height  
    # return the computed bmi value
```

Test your solution

```
# typical values  
assert round(calculate_bmi(70, 1.75), 2) == 22.86  
assert round(calculate_bmi(60, 1.6), 2) == 23.44
```

Test your solution

```
# edge-like scenarios  
assert round(calculate_bmi(90, 2.0), 2) == 22.5  
assert round(calculate_bmi(45, 1.5), 2) == 20.0
```


Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Convert Minutes to Hours and Minutes

Exercise Description

Implement a function `convert_minutes(total_minutes)` that takes a non-negative integer number of minutes and returns a tuple `(hours, minutes)` representing the equivalent hours and remaining minutes.

Your solution

```
def convert_minutes(total_minutes):  
    # compute how many whole hours are contained in the total minutes using integer division  
    # compute the remaining minutes using the remainder operator with 60  
    # return the pair (hours, minutes) as a tuple
```

Test your solution

```
# basic cases
assert convert_minutes(0) == (0, 0)
assert convert_minutes(59) == (0, 59)
assert convert_minutes(60) == (1, 0)
```

Test your solution

```
# additional values
assert convert_minutes(125) == (2, 5)
assert convert_minutes(240) == (4, 0)
```

Debug your solution

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from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Minimum of Two Numbers

Exercise Description

Create a function `min_of_two(a, b)` that returns the smaller of two numbers `a` and `b`.

Your solution

```
def min_of_two(a, b):  
    # check if a is less than b  
    # if true, return a because it is the smaller value  
    # otherwise  
    # return b because it is less than or equal to a
```

Test your solution

```
# typical comparisons  
assert min_of_two(3, 5) == 3  
assert min_of_two(-1, 2) == -1  
assert min_of_two(7, 7) == 7
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Determine Grade Based on Score

Exercise Description

Write a function `determine_grade(score)` that returns a letter grade based on a numeric score from 0 to 100 inclusive. Use the following scale: A for 90+, B for 80–89, C for 70–79, D for 60–69, F for below 60.

Your solution

```
def determine_grade(score):  
    # if score is greater than or equal to 90 then return 'A'  
    # else if score is greater than or equal to 80 then return 'B'  
    # else if score is greater than or equal to 70 then return 'C'  
    # else if score is greater than or equal to 60 then return 'D'  
    # otherwise return 'F'
```

Test your solution

```
# boundary checks  
assert determine_grade(100) == 'A'  
assert determine_grade(90) == 'A'  
assert determine_grade(89) == 'B'  
assert determine_grade(80) == 'B'  
assert determine_grade(79) == 'C'  
assert determine_grade(70) == 'C'  
assert determine_grade(69) == 'D'  
assert determine_grade(60) == 'D'
```

```
assert determine_grade(59) == 'F'  
assert determine_grade(0) == 'F'
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pythontutor.'
```

Exercise: Convert Fahrenheit to Celsius

Exercise Description

Implement a function `fahrenheit_to_celsius(fahrenheit)` that converts a temperature in Fahrenheit to Celsius using the formula $C = (F - 32) * 5 / 9$. Return the Celsius value as a float.

Your solution

```
def fahrenheit_to_celsius(fahrenheit):  
    # subtract 32 from the fahrenheit temperature  
    # multiply the result by 5
```

